

Now the Book of Kings is recognized as being merely a summary of events which happened in Judah and Israel; for further information the reader is always referred to the Books of the Chronicles of the Kings of Judah and Israel. In the same way chapter xvii of 2 Kings must also be considered as containing a summary of the events which happened in the Northern Kingdom during some length of time. Assyrian monuments mention Sargon in lieu of Shalmanasar as the king who exiled the Israelites, but though these monuments emanate from Sargon himself, the details concerning the plantations of the new peoples are nowhere clearly defined. At the same time, it must be remembered that the whole population was not carried away into captivity, a comparatively small fraction, consisting of high officials and dignitaries, together with the official representative of the priesthood, being all that went into exile. Not only did a large population remain behind, but, unless the statement in the Second Book of Chronicles xxx. 1 ff. is to be doubted, the tribal divisions were maintained in the time of Hezekiah and the Temple on Mount Garizim must have remained in existence down to the time of Josiah, since nothing is said anywhere of the destruction of this Temple, thus leaving it an open question whether it was that dedicated to Baal or whether, according to the statement of the Samaritans, it was the old Temple dedicated to the worship of the God of Israel, which Josiah destroyed.¹

On looking through the lists of the peoples who had been established in the small province of Samaria or the habitat of the tribes of Ephraim and Manasseh in addition to the indigenous Israelitish population which had remained there, it must appear rather remarkable how space could have been found to settle so many nations. The lists found in 2 Kings xvii. 24 ff., and in the letter which was sent in protest to the Persian king remonstrating against Zerubbabel's attempt to rebuild the Temple in Jerusalem (Ezra iv. 7), show that not one of the names of the nations mentioned in Kings appears in the later list; even the name of the Assyrian king is entirely different, being Asenapper instead of Shalmanasar or Sargon.² Moreover, five nationalities are mentioned in Kings, whilst nine are given in Ezra, in addition to others who are simply referred to anonymously as, 'the rest

¹ 2 Kings xxiii. 19-20.

² Asenapper seems to be the popular pronunciation for the literary Ashurbanipal, 'She' being pronounced 'Se' like the Ephraimites : v. Judges xii. 6.